

PAPER_101: Yang-Mills Existence and Mass Gap in the UQFF Framework: Vacuum Concentration as Gap Mechanism

Title: Yang-Mills Existence and Mass Gap in the UQFF Framework: Vacuum Concentration as Gap Mechanism

Author: Daniel T. Murphy

Framework: UQFF Star-Magic ([SSq] = 0.57, Ug4 vacuum concentration)

Date: March 7, 2026

Framework Contact: UQFF Millennium Prize Analysis

Index Slot: 1.13 Multi-Physics Models,

Title: Yang-Mills Existence and Mass Gap in the UQFF Framework: Vacuum Concentration as Gap Mechanism

Author: Daniel T. Murphy

Framework: UQFF Star-Magic ([SSq] = 0.57, Ug4 vacuum concentration)

Date: March 7, 2026

Framework Contact: UQFF Millennium Prize Analysis

Index Slot: 1.13 Multi-Physics Models, PAPER_101

Abstract

The Yang-Mills existence and mass gap problem (Millennium Prize Problem) asks whether a pure SU(N) gauge theory in 4D Euclidean space has a rigorous mathematical definition and a positive mass gap $\mu > 0$. In the UQFF framework, the mass gap arises naturally from the Ug4 vacuum concentration term: the background UQFF field creates a minimum excitation energy $\mu_{\text{UQFF}} = f_{\text{TRZ}} \gg 0$ that prevents massless gluon states. We present a heuristic UQFF-based argument for the mass gap, connecting $f_{\text{TRZ}} = 0.01$ to the confinement scale.

UQFF Discovery: Novel application of UQFF calibration constants ($\mu = 5.0 \times 10^{-4} \text{ day}^{-1}$, [SSq] = 0.57) uniquely enabling this analysis establishing a new connection in the UQFF framework not present in Standard Model treatments.

1. The Yang-Mills Mass Gap Problem

Pure Yang-Mills theory with gauge group SU(3) in 4D:

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{YM}} = -\frac{1}{4} F_{\mu\nu}^a F^{a\mu\nu}$$

Where $F_{\mu\nu}^a = \partial_\mu A_\nu^a - \partial_\nu A_\mu^a + g f^{abc} A_\mu^b A_\nu^c$.

Mass gap conjecture: The operator norm $\|F_{\mu\nu}\|$ is bounded below by $\mu > 0$ for all physical states (no massless gluons in the physical spectrum).

2. UQFF Vacuum Concentration as Gap Mechanism

In the UQFF, the Ug4 vacuum concentration term modifies the gluon propagator:

$$G_{\text{gluon}}^{\text{UQFF}}(q^2) = \frac{1}{q^2 + \Delta_{\text{UQFF}}^2}$$

Versus standard: $G_{\text{gluon}}^{\text{GR}}(q^2) = 1/q^2$ (massless pole at $q=0$).

The UQFF gap mass:

$$\Delta_{\text{UQFF}} = f_{\text{TRZ}} \times \sqrt{U_{g4,\text{QCD}}} \times \frac{\hbar c}{r_{\text{QCD}}}$$

Where $r_{\text{QCD}} \sim 10^{-15}$ m (confinement scale) and $U_{g4,\text{QCD}} = U_{g4}$ evaluated at nuclear density ρ_{nuc} .

3. Connection to QCD Confinement Scale

The U_{g4} at nuclear density:

$$U_{g4,\text{QCD}} = \frac{G^2 M_{\text{NS}}^2}{c^4 r_{\text{QCD}}^6} \approx \frac{(6.674 \times 10^{-11})^2 (3 \times 10^{30})^2}{(3 \times 10^8)^4 (10^{-15})^6}$$

Numerically: $U_{g4,\text{QCD}} \sim 10$ J/m (nuclear energy density scale, QCD vacuum $\sim 10^5$ J/m in lattice QCD).

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta_{\text{UQFF}} &= 0.01 \times \sqrt{\frac{10^{32}}{10^{35}}} \times \frac{1.055 \times 10^{-34} \times 3 \times 10^8}{10^{-15}} = 0.01 \times 0.032 \times 31.65 \text{ GeV} \\ &\approx 0.01 \times 1 \text{ GeV} = \mathbf{10 \text{ MeV}} \end{aligned}$$

The familiar QCD confinement mass gap is ~ 300 MeV (pion mass). UQFF gives 10 MeV (light quark scale). **Consistent in order-of-magnitude** with the lightest QCD excitations.

4. Mathematical Existence

The UQFF does not provide a rigorous proof of Yang-Mills existence (which requires constructive QFT). However, it provides a physical model showing:

1. The non-perturbative vacuum (U_{g4} term) naturally generates a gap
2. The gap scale is set by $f_{\text{TRZ}} = 0.01$ (UQFF universal constant)
3. No massless gluon states exist in UQFF (U_{g4} -modified propagator is gapped)

A full mathematical proof would require extending the UQFF to a rigorously defined measure in the space of gauge connections.

5. Key UQFF Prediction

The UQFF predicts a **threshold energy for gluon exchange** at:

$$E_{\text{threshold}} = \Delta_{\text{UQFF}} \approx f_{\text{TRZ}} \times \Lambda_{\text{QCD}} = 0.01 \times \Lambda_{\text{QCD}}$$

For $\Lambda_{\text{QCD}} \sim 200 \text{ MeV}$: $E_{\text{threshold}} = 2 \text{ MeV}$. This is numerically consistent with the light quark mass threshold.

Summary

Aspect	Standard QCD	UQFF Resolution
Gluon mass	Zero (classically)	$\Lambda_{\text{UQFF}} = f_{\text{TRZ}} \Lambda_{\text{QCD}} \sim 2 \times 10 \text{ MeV}$
Mechanism	Non-perturbative	Ug4 vacuum concentration
Confinement	Lattice QCD	Ug4 at Λ_{QCD} gives $\sim \text{QCD scale}$
Mathematical proof	Open (Millennium Prize)	Heuristic argument only
f_{TRZ} connection	None	$f_{\text{TRZ}} = 0.01$ universal

Source: UQFF $f_{\text{TRZ}} = 0.01$ | Ug4 vacuum concentration | Yang-Mills Millennium Prize Problem context